



Discovery Piscine

Module 8 - Python

Summary: In this Module, we see how to use functions and scopes.

Version: 2.1

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Chapter I

A word about this Discovery Piscine

Welcome!

You will begin a Module of this Discovery Piscine of computer programming. Our goal is to introduce you to the code behind the software you use daily and immerse you in peer learning, the educational model of 42.

Programming is about logic, not mathematics. It gives you basic building blocks that you can assemble in countless ways. There is no single “correct” solution to a problem—your solution will be unique, just as each of your peers’ solutions will be.

Fast or slow, elegant or messy, as long as it works, that’s what matters! These building blocks will form a sequence of instructions (for calculations, displays, etc.) that the computer will execute in the order you design.

Instead of providing you with a course where each problem has only one solution, we place you in a peer-learning environment. You’ll search for elements that could help you tackle your challenge, refine them through testing and experimentation, and ultimately create your own program. Discuss with others, share your perspectives, come up with new ideas together, and test everything yourself to ensure it works.

Peer evaluation is a key opportunity to discover alternative approaches and spot potential issues in your program that you may have missed (consider how frustrating a program crash can be). Each reviewer will approach your work differently—like clients with varying expectations—giving you fresh perspectives. You may even form connections for future collaborations.

By the end of this Piscine, your journey will be unique. You will have tackled different challenges, validated different projects, and chosen different paths than others—and that’s perfectly fine! This is both a collective and individual experience, and everyone will gain something from it.

Good luck to all; we hope you enjoy this journey of discovery.